

William Johnston

CURRICULUM VITAE

Département de linguistique
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EDUCATION

Ph.D., 2024	Linguistics, McGill University	
	Dissertation: <i>Event structure and serial verbs in Hmong</i> . Supervisors: Jessica Coon and Luis Alonso-Ovalle. Committee members: Junko Shimoyama and Lisa Travis. External examiner: Peter Svenonius (University of Tromsø).	
B.A., 2013	Linguistics, Carleton College (Northfield, MN)	

EMPLOYMENT

Fall 2024–Present	Postdoctoral researcher Université du Québec à Montréal, Département de linguistique Fonds de recherche du Québec (FRQ) Postdoctoral Fellowship Supervisor: Richard Compton.
Fall 2025–Spring 2026	Parental leave
Fall 2024	Course Lecturer Université du Québec à Montréal, Département de linguistique
Winter 2023	Course Lecturer McGill University, Department of Linguistics
Winter 2021	Course Lecturer McGill University, Department of Linguistics

RESEARCH

GRANTS & FELLOWSHIPS

Fonds de recherche du Québec (FRQ) Postdoctoral Fellowship, 2024–2027.
Syntactic categories in White Hmong: Implications for linguistic theory and language education | *Les catégories syntaxiques en hmong blanc: implications pour la théorie linguistique et l'enseignement des langues*. \$90,000.

JOURNAL ARTICLES

Johnston, William. (2023). “Pair-list answers to questions with plural definites.” *Semantics and Pragmatics* 16(2). 

CONFERENCE PROCEEDINGS

Johnston, William. (2025). “Decomposing Path: Deprepositional verbs in White Hmong”  In Shweta Akolkar, Amber Galvano, Akil Ismael, Kang Franco Liu, & Line Mikkelsen (eds.), *Proceedings of the 42nd West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics*, 174–181. Somerville, MA: Cascadilla Press.

Johnston, William. (2025). “Culmination entailments in V and P: Evidence from White Hmong.”  In Yağmur Kiper, Larry Lyu, Richard Wang, & Niko Webster (eds.), *Proceedings of the 41st West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics*, 262–269. Somerville, MA: Cascadilla Press.

Johnston, William. (2024). “Two diagnostics for preposition-hood: Decomposing Path in White Hmong.”  In Xiangyu Li, Zetao Xu, Yuqiao Du, Zhuo Chen, Chenghao Hu, Zhongyang Yu, & Victor Junnan Pan (eds.), *Proceedings of the 14th Generative Linguistics in the Old World in Asia (GLOW in Asia XIV)*, 131–145. Chinese University of Hong Kong.

Johnston, William. (2022). “Nonspecific promises: The Intensional Restitution Effect.” In Daniel Gutzmann & Sophie Repp (eds.), *Proceedings of Sinn und Bedeutung* 26, 483–502. University of Cologne.

Johnston, William. (2019). “Pair-list questions from dependent plurals.” In Julian J. Schlöder, Dean McHugh, & Floris Roelofsen (eds.), *Proceedings of the 22nd Amsterdam Colloquium*, 201–210. Amsterdam: ILLC.

MANUSCRIPTS

Johnston, William. (Resubmitted). “Paths across worlds: the presupposition of ‘back’ in intensional contexts.”

Johnston, William. (In revision). “Causation and serialization in White Hmong.”

INVITED TALKS

“Causation and serialization in Hmong.” *Converging on Causal Ontology Analyses*. Centre national de la recherche scientifique (CNRS), Paris. October 11, 2024.

“Path in Hmong: The structure of directional PPs.” *Annual Conference of the Canadian Linguistic Association*. Carleton University, Ottawa. June 19, 2024.

“The verb phrase in Hmong: Serialization and event structure.” *University of Minnesota Linguistics Colloquium Series*. University of Minnesota, Minneapolis. Nov. 11, 2022.

REFEREED CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- “A (de)prepositional approach to directed motion predicates in Cantonese and Hmong” (with Justin Leung). *Theoretical East Asian Linguistics (TEAL) 14*, University of Southern California, Los Angeles, CA. March 19, 2025.
- “Parts of speech in Hmong.” *6th Hmong Studies Consortium International Conference*, Merced College, Merced, CA. November 2, 2024.
- “Clausal Complementation, Finiteness and Object Control in Hmong” (with Hooi Ling Soh). *33rd Annual Meeting of the Southeast Asian Linguistics Society (SEALS 33)*, National Tsing Hua University, Hsinchu, Taiwan. June 15, 2024. *Presented by co-author.*
- “Directed motion in White Hmong: Serial verb constructions as complex PPs.” *Montreal-Ottawa-Toronto-Hamilton Syntax Workshop (MOTH 2022)*, Université du Québec à Montréal. April 23, 2022.
- “Verb serialization as event-building: Evidence from Hmong.” *96th Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Society of America (LSA)*, Washington, DC. January 9, 2022.
- “Nonspecific promises: The Intensional Restitution Effect.” *Sinn und Bedeutung 26*, University of Cologne. September 10, 2021.
- “Nonspecific promises: The Intensional Restitution Effect.” *Toronto-Ottawa-Montreal Semantics Workshop (TOM) 13*, University of Toronto. May 21, 2021.
- “Verb serialization as event-building: Evidence from Hmong.” *Montreal-Ottawa-Toronto-Hamilton Syntax Workshop (MOTH 2021)*, McMaster University. April 19, 2021.
- “Pair-list questions from dependent plurals.” *22nd Amsterdam Colloquium*, University of Amsterdam. December 19, 2019.

REFEREED CONFERENCE POSTERS

- “Diagnosing Prepositions: Decomposing Path in White Hmong.” *42nd West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics (WCCFL 42)*. April 13, 2024.
- “Diagnosing Prepositions: Decomposing Path in White Hmong.” *Generative Linguistics in the Old World in Asia (GLOW in Asia XIV)*, Chinese University of Hong Kong. March 6, 2024.
- “Culmination entailments in V and P: Evidence from White Hmong.” *41st West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics (WCCFL 41)*, University of California Santa Cruz. May 6, 2023.
- “Focus, too, and conjunction, too: The syntax and semantics of Japanese *mo*-coordination.” *Minnesota Undergraduate Linguistics Symposium*, St. Olaf College. April 13, 2013.

TEACHING

COURSES TAUGHT

Fall 2024	Language Awareness for ESL Teachers (LIN1130) Université du Québec à Montréal, Département de linguistique
Winter 2023	Languages of the World (LING 315) McGill University, Department of Linguistics
Winter 2021	Meaning in Language (LING 260) McGill University, Department of Linguistics

TEACHING ASSISTANTSHIPS

Fall 2021	Phonetics (LING 330) Connie Ting, McGill University Department of Linguistics
Fall 2020	Meaning in Language (LING 260) Bernhard Schwarz, McGill University Department of Linguistics
Winter 2020	Phonetics (LING 330) Francisco Torreira, McGill University Department of Linguistics
Fall 2019	Phonetics (LING 330) Meghan Clayards, McGill University Department of Linguistics
Fall 2012	Introduction to Linguistics (LING 110) Cherlon Ussery, Carleton College Linguistics Department.

GRADING

Fall 2020	Structure of a Specific Language - German (LING 410) Bernhard Schwarz, McGill University Dept. of Linguistics
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AWARDS

2023–2024	Graduate Research Enhancement and Travel Award, McGill University Faculty of Arts, \$640 Graduate Student Travel Award, Centre for Research on Brain, Language and Music, \$700
2022–2023	Graduate Excellence Fellowship, McGill University, \$20,000 McGill Linguistics Department Travel Fund, \$1,000

2021–2022	Graduate Excellence Award, McGill University, \$15,000. Graduate Research Enhancement and Travel Award, McGill University Faculty of Arts, \$141
2020–2021	Cremona Memorial Fellowship, McGill University, \$10,000 Linguistics Department Nominee, Arts Graduate Student Teaching Award, McGill University.
2019–2020	Graduate Excellence Award, McGill University, \$1,000
2018–2019	Graduate Excellence Award, McGill University, \$15,000

SERVICE & COMMUNITY

DEPARTMENT ORGANIZING

2019–2021	Editor, <i>McLing</i> Newsletter McGill University Department of Linguistics
Summer 2021	Organizer, Event Structure Reading Group McGill University Department of Linguistics
Spring 2021	Co-organizer, Accepted Students Open House McGill University Department of Linguistics
Spring 2020	Co-organizer, Accepted Students Open House McGill University Department of Linguistics

CONFERENCE ORGANIZING

Spring 2023	Workshop on Structure and Constituency in Languages of the Americas (WSCLA 2023)
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READING AND RESEARCH GROUPS

2022–Present	University of Minnesota Community-Engaged Hmong Linguistics Research and Reading Group
2020–Present	Montreal Underdocumented Languages Linguistics Lab
2018–Present	McGill Syntax/Semantics Reading Group
Summer 2021	McGill Event Structure Reading Group

PROFESSIONAL ORGANIZATIONS

2024–Present	Canadian Linguistic Association (CLA)
2024–Present	Generative Linguistics in the Old World (GLOW)
2023–Present	Hmong Studies Consortium
2021–Present	Linguistic Society of America (LSA)

OUTREACH

Spring 2023	Panel: “Ask a Grad Student” Society of Linguistics Undergrads at McGill
Spring 2022	Panel: “Ask a Grad Student” Society of Linguistics Undergrads at McGill
Winter 2015	Panel: “What paths will a linguistics major take you on?” Carleton College Linguistics Department

REVIEWING

CONFERENCE ABSTRACTS: Annual Conference on African Linguistics (ACAL), Canadian Linguistic Association (CLA)

CONFERENCE PROCEEDINGS: Toronto–Montreal Bantu Colloquium (Ba-TOM)

NON-DEGREE COURSEWORK

Fall 2020	Hmong Language Workshop, Southeast Asian Diaspora Project Minneapolis MN
Summer 2013	Denver Publishing Institute, University of Denver

PREVIOUS PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Jan. 2014–Jul. 2018	Financial Advisor, Morgan Stanley Wealth Management Minneapolis MN
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